

Twisters

Twisters, or tornadoes, are whirling funnels of air. They hang down from thunderstorm clouds, which form in very hot and humid weather. Twisters usually last about 15 minutes, but if the bottom of a funnel touches the ground, it will smash everything in its path instantly.



Twisters are like the funnel that forms when water is sucked down a drain.

Twister alert

If you see thunderclouds with small, rounded “lumps” beneath them, they are a good sign that a tornado is on the way. These bulging clouds are called mammatus clouds.

White column

Inside a tornado, air is sucked upward and starts to spin at enormous speed. An approaching tornado is white, because it has not yet touched the ground and picked up dust and debris.